

products you weren't planning on purchasing that trip. Then, and only then, abandon your list and take advantage of the tremendous savings. Nearly half of my stockpile is items that came from clearance shelves or discounted carts—items I had not intended on purchasing but did anyway—because they were either free with my coupons, or cost just pennies. And we all know how quickly those pennies saved add up.

Watch out for impulse buys. This goes right along with having a list, but also includes those last-minute purchases encouraged while we are waiting in line. Pricey convenience items such as candy, mints, and interesting magazines are often located near the checkout stands, encouraging spur-of-the-moment purchases. The placement of merchandise is not left to chance. Makeup might be located near the women's shoes, high-priced salsa next to the sale-priced tortilla chips, or stuffed animals located at child's level precisely for the purpose of encouraging impulse buys

Beware the “paired” products. Be careful of store displays that pair up something expensive with the sale item on the shelves. Maybe the spaghetti on the endcap is the one-dollar sale price, but the sauce on the bottom shelf is the highest-priced sauce in the store.

Sneaky signs and sale prices. Don't let a sign dictate your purchases. Many sales (10 for \$10) tempt the consumer to buy more of a product than they normally would. You usually don't have to buy ten to get the sale price of a dollar. Be careful. Sometimes the sale price isn't a good deal at all if the regular price is already one dollar.